

Lab: Refine Your Product Backlog with GitHub

Estimated time needed: 20 minutes

In this lab, you will follow the steps of conducting a backlog refinement meeting. You will be the product owner getting the product backlog ready for your next sprint planning meeting. This involves grooming the stories we created in the last lab to make them *sprint ready*.

Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

1. Triage new issues
 2. Make stories sprint ready
 3. Create new labels
 4. Add labels to stories
-

Initial state

At the completion of [Hands-on-lab: Assemble your Product Backlog Using GitHub](#), your Kanban board should look like this:

 **Lab Agile Planning** 

Lab Agile Planning

 Backlog 

 Priority board

 Team items

 Roadmap

 Filter by keyword or by field

 **New issues** 3 / 7 Estimate: 0 

 lab-agile-planning #5
Deploy service to the cloud

 lab-agile-planning #6
Need the ability to remove a counter

 lab-agile-planning #7
Need the ability to update a counter to a new value

 Add item

 **Icebox** 1 Est

 lab-agile-planning #
Must allow multiple

 Add item



New Issues:

- Deploy service to the cloud
- Need the ability to remove a counter
- Need ability to update a counter to a new value

Icebox:

- Must allow multiple counters

Product Backlog:

- Need a service that has a counter
- Must persist counter across restarts
- Counters can be reset

Exercise 1: Triage new issues

In this exercise, you will take all of the stories in the **New issues** column and move them to an appropriate column or reject them.

1. Go to github.com and sign in with your GitHub account and bring up your Kanban board.

The screenshot shows a GitHub Project Kanban board for 'Lab Agile Planning'. The board has four columns: 'Backlog', 'Priority board', 'Team items', and 'Roadmap'. The 'Backlog' column is selected and shows three issues: 'lab-agile-planning #5' (Deploy service to the cloud), 'lab-agile-planning #6' (Need the ability to remove a counter), and 'lab-agile-planning #7' (Need the ability to update a counter to a new value). The 'Icebox' column is also visible with one issue: 'lab-agile-planning #8' (Must allow multiple). The board includes a filter bar at the top and a scroll bar at the bottom.

2. The first new issue is **Deploy service to the cloud**. We want to do that after adding persistence, so move that to the **Product Backlog** column under **Must persist counter across restarts**.

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Lab Agile Planning

Backlog Priority board Team items Roadmap In review My items

Filter by keyword or by field

New issues 2 / 7 Estimate: 0

- lab-agile-planning #6
Need the ability to remove a counter
- lab-agile-planning #7
Need the ability to update a counter to a new value

Icebox 1 Estimate: 0

- lab-agile-planning #2
Must allow multiple counters

+ Add item + Add item

3. The next new issue is **Need the ability to remove a counter**. We only have one counter and we wouldn't want to remove that, so let's move that to the **Icebox** after **Must allow multiple counters**.

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Lab Agile Planning

Backlog Priority board Team items Roadmap In review My items

Filter by keyword or by field

New issues 1 / 7 Estimate: 0

lab-agile-planning #7
Need the ability to update a counter to a new value

Icebox 2 Estimate: 0

lab-agile-planning #2
Must allow multiple counters

lab-agile-planning #6
Need the ability to remove a counter

+ Add item

4. The last new issue is **Need ability to update a counter to a new value**. We might want to do that as an enhancement after we can reset the counter, so let's move that to the **Product Backlog** after **Counters can be reset**.

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Lab Agile Planning

Backlog Priority board Team items Roadmap In review My items + New

Filter by keyword or by field

New issues 0 / 7 Estimate: 0

Icebox 2 Estimate: 0

Product Backlog Estimate: 0

lab-agile-planning #2 Must allow multiple counters

lab-agile-planning #6 Need the ability to remove a counter

lab-agile-planning #7 Need the ability to remove a counter

+ Add item + Add item + Add item

You have now completed new issue triage and can start making the stories in the **Product Backlog** column sprint ready.

Exercise 2: Make stories sprint ready

In this exercise, you will add more details to the stories in the **Product Backlog** that you feel might make it into the next sprint. You will be provided with the details for two of the stories. You must provide the details for the other three.

1. Select the first story at the top of the **Product Backlog** column to open it. Click on the three dots then select the **Edit** button to edit the issue.

The screenshot shows a GitHub interface. At the top, the breadcrumb navigation is 'Projects / Lab Agile Planning'. The left sidebar contains a 'Backlog' section with a 'New issue' button and a 'Filter by key' dropdown. The main content area displays the title 'Need a service that has a counter' with an 'Open' status and a repository path '/lab-agile-planning'. Below the title, a light blue banner indicates the issue was opened 5 days ago. The issue body contains the following text:

As a user
I need a service that has a counter
So that I can keep track of how many times something was

Details and Assumptions

- [document what you know]

Acceptance Criteria

2. Edit the **Details and Assumptions** to let developers know what we know, and edit the **Acceptance Criteria** to make sure that everyone understands what the definition of "done" is. Make your story look like this one:

Need a service that has a counter #1

 Open

Zohra539/lab-agile-planning

Public



Zohra539 opened 5 days ago

Write

Preview

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****As a**** User

****I need**** a service that has a counter

****So that**** I can keep track of how many times something was done

Details and Assumptions

- * Need a way to increment a counter

- * Need a way to get the current value

Acceptance Criteria

``Gherkin

Given I have incremented the counter to 2

When I make a call to get the current value

Then it should return 2 as the counter value

``



Paste, drop, or click to add files

3. When you are finished editing, press the **Save** button to save the edits.

Need a service that has a counter #1

 Open

Zetool /lab-agile-planning

Public



Zetool opened 5 days ago

Write

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****As a** User**

****I need** a service that has a counter**

****So that** I can keep track of how many times something was done**

Details and Assumptions

* Need a way to increment a counter

* Need a way to get the current value

Acceptance Criteria

``Gherkin

Given I have incremented the counter to 2

When I make a call to get the current value

Then it should return 2 as the counter value

```



Paste, drop, or click to add files

4. Close the window by pressing the X icon.

The screenshot shows a GitHub interface. At the top, the breadcrumb is 'Zehra539 / Projects / Lab Agile Planning'. The left sidebar shows the 'Lab Agile Planning' repository with a 'Backlog' view and a 'Filter by key' option. A 'New issue' button is visible. The main content area shows an issue titled 'Need a service that has a c'. Below the title are buttons for 'Open' and 'Public'. A light blue banner indicates the issue was opened 5 days ago. The issue body contains the following text:

As a User
I need a service that has a counter
So that I can keep track of how many times something wa

Details and Assumptions

- Need a way to increment a counter
- Need a way to get the current value

Acceptance Criteria

Given I have incremented the counter to 2
When I make a call to get the current value
Then it should return 2 as the counter value

5. Edit the **Must persist counter across restarts** story in the same way and make it look like the following:



Must persist counter across restarts #3

/lab-agile-planning

Write

Preview

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****As a**** Service Provider

****I need**** the service to persist the last known count

****So that**** users don't lose track of their counts after the service is restarted

Details and Assumptions

- We will use a Redis database
- Counter will be stored as a name-value pair

Acceptance Criteria

``gherkin

Given I have incremented the counter to 2

When I restart the service

Then the counter should still return 2

``

Paste, drop, or click to add files

6. Edit the following stories with your own details, assumptions, and acceptance criteria:

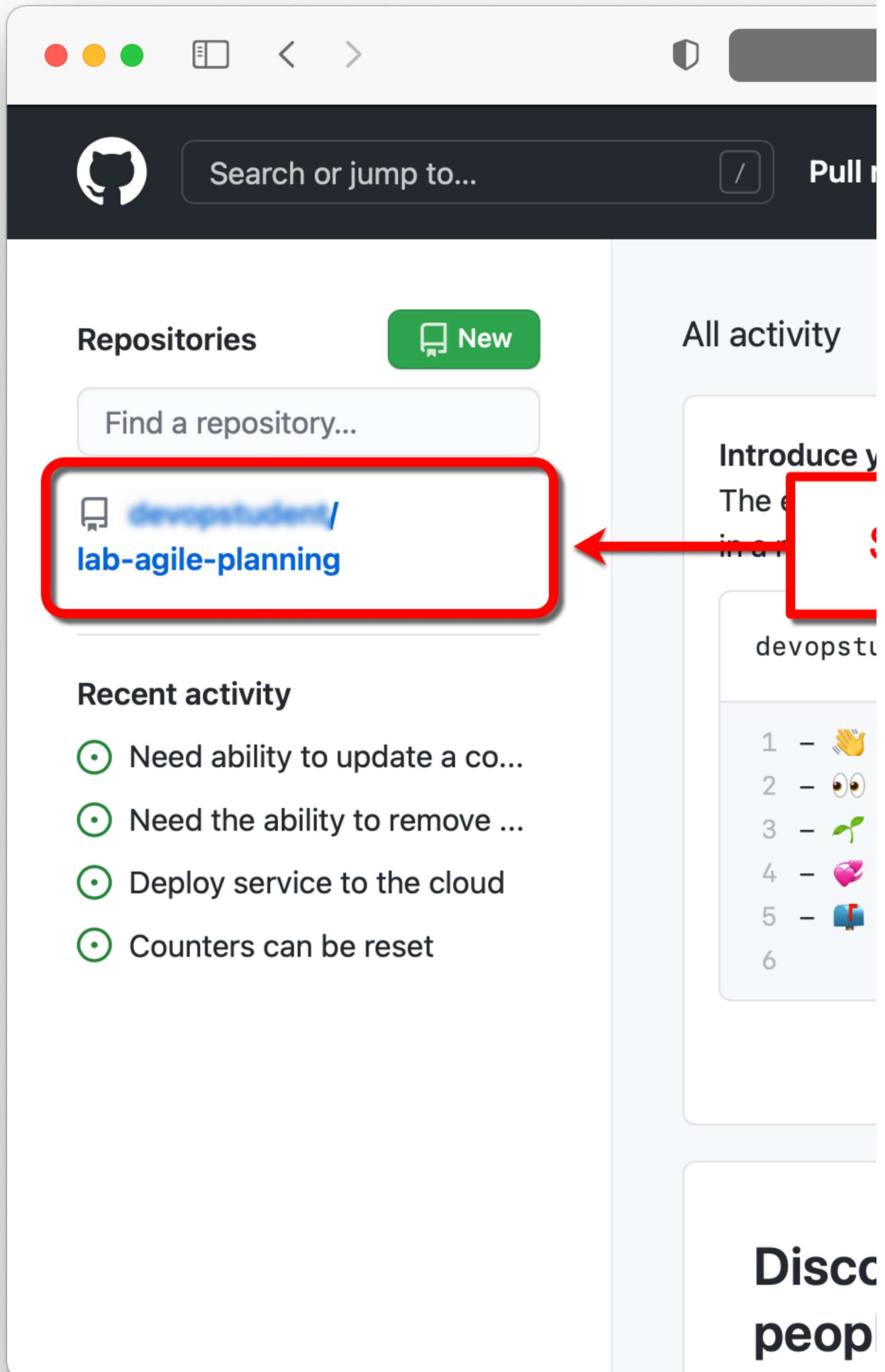
1. **Deploy service to the cloud**
2. **Counters can be reset**
3. **Need ability to update a counter to a new value**

At the completion of this exercise, your Kanban board should have sufficient details in all of the stories in the **Product Backlog** to make them sprint ready.

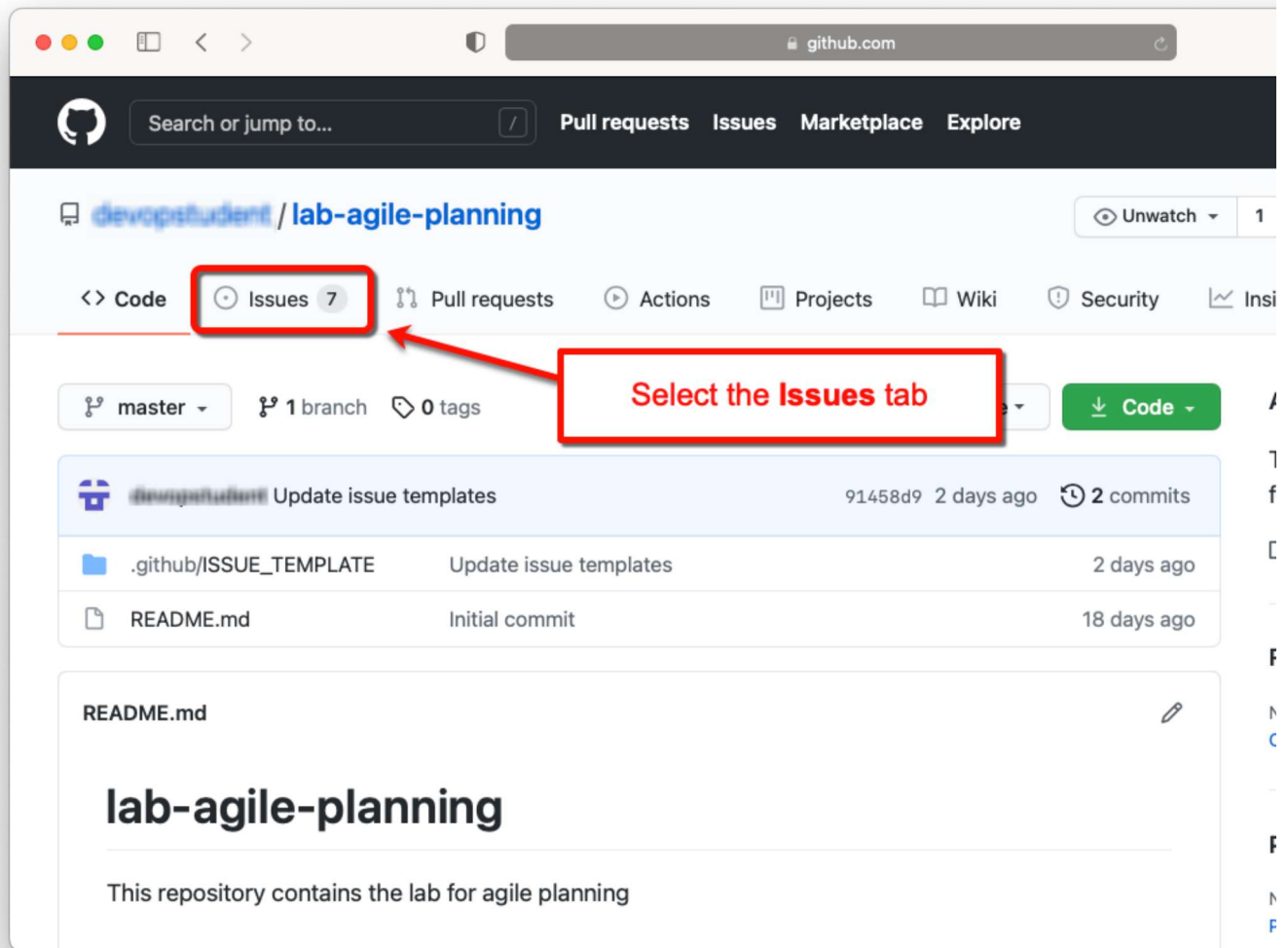
Exercise 3: Create new labels in GitHub

In this exercise, you will create a new label in GitHub called `technical debt` to flag those stories that provide no visible customer value but must be completed in order to continue development.

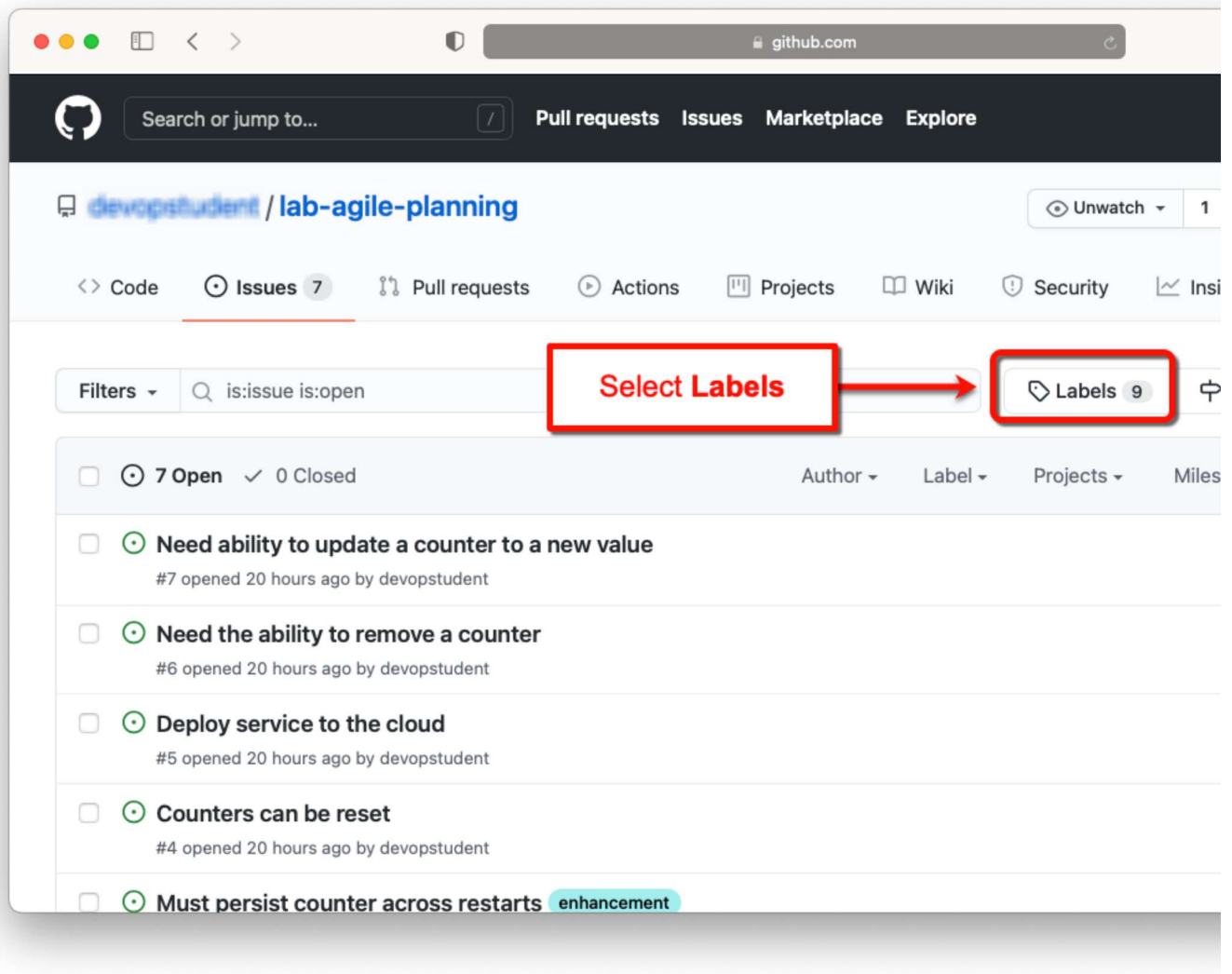
1. Go to github.com and select your **lab-agile-planning** repository.



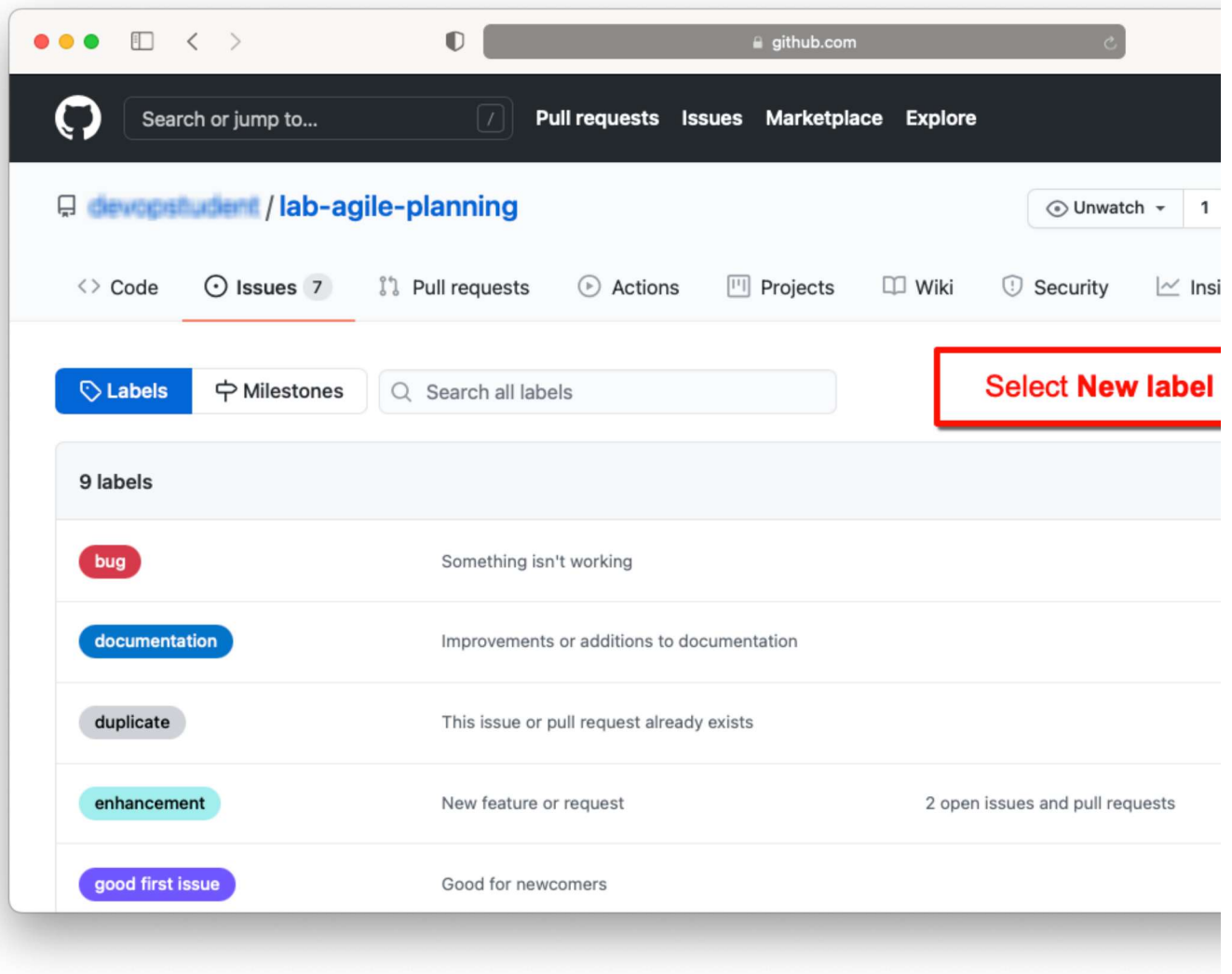
2. From your repository page, select the Issues tab.



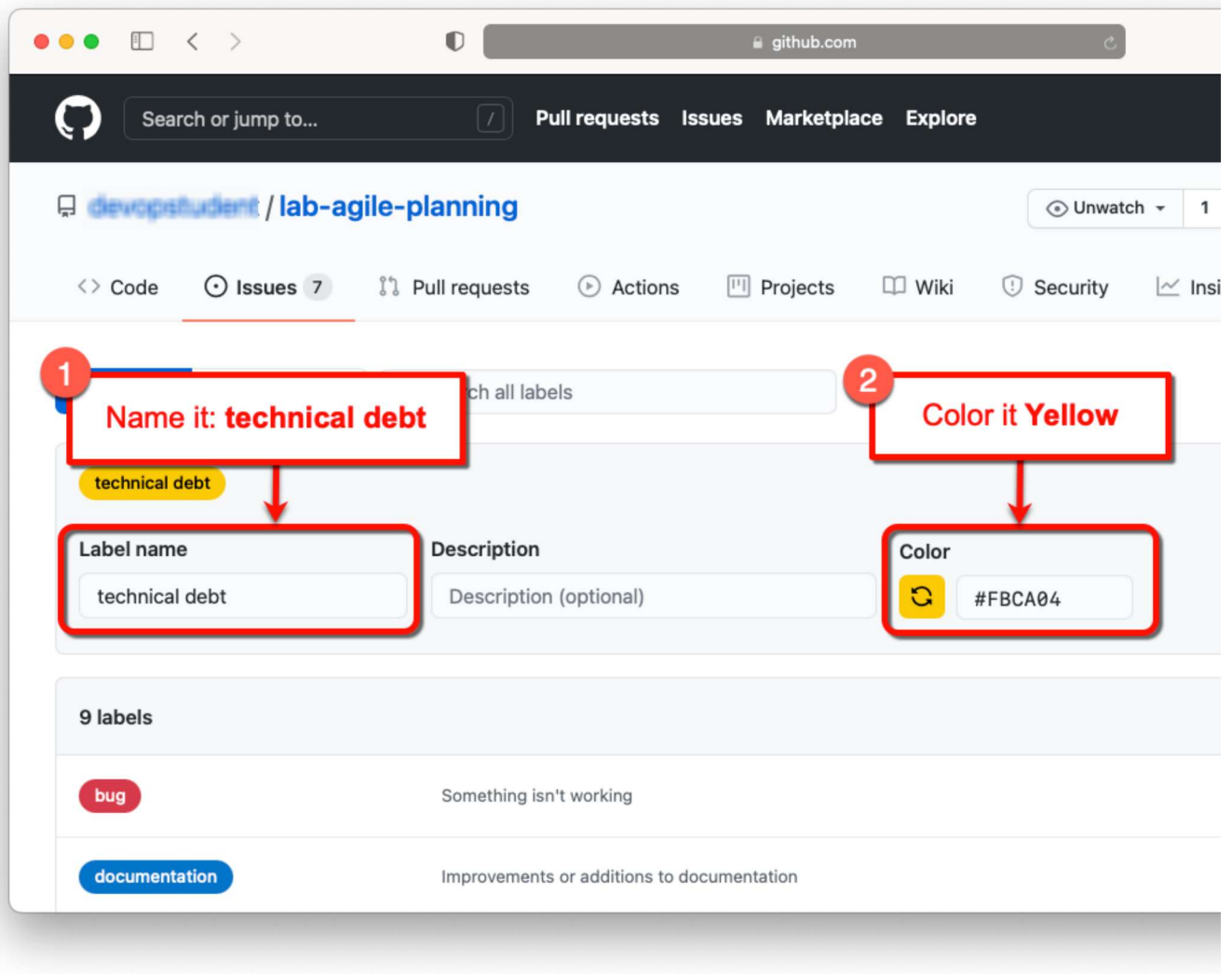
3. From the issues page, select the Labels button.



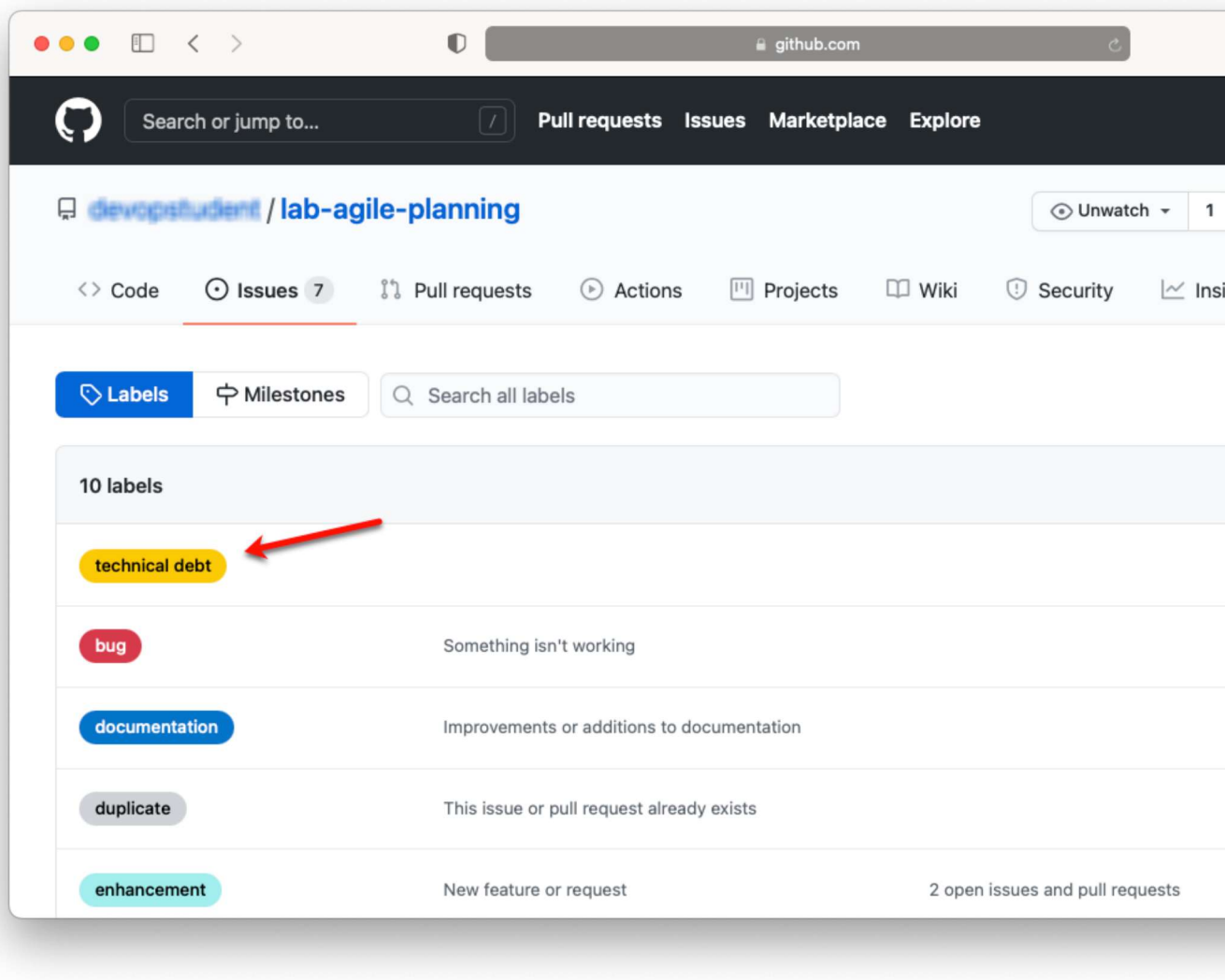
4. From the labels page, select the New label button.



5. In the new label section: (1) set the **Label name** to technical debt, (2) set the **Color** to yellow (#FBCA04), then (3) press the **Create label** button.



6. You should now see a yellow technical debt label that we can use to annotate our stories.



Exercise 4: Add labels to stories

In this exercise, you will add labels to the stories in the **Product Backlog** to further make them sprint ready. You will also use our new label called **technical debt** to flag those stories that provide no visible customer value but must be completed to continue development.

1. Select the first story at the top of the **Product Backlog** column to open it. Then, press the **Gear** icon next to **Labels** to assign a label.

 **Lab Agile Planning** / Projects / **Lab Agile Planning**

Lab Agile Planning

 Backlog

Filter by key

New issue
is item hasn't

Add item

Need a service that has a counter

 **Open**

 **Lab Agile Planning** / lab-agile-planning **Public**

 **Lab Agile Planning** opened 5 days ago

As a User
I need a service that has a counter
So that I can keep track of how many times something was done

Details and Assumptions

- Need a way to increment a counter
- Need a way to get the current value

Acceptance Criteria

Given I have incremented the counter to 2
When I make a call to get the current value
Then it should return 2 as the counter value

2. Our first story is an enhancement to our product. From the label menu, select enhancement to reflect this.

Zehev539 / Projects / Lab Agile Planning

Open

 Zehev539/lab-agile-planning

Public

 Zehev539 opened 5 days ago

As a User

I need a service that has a counter

So that I can keep track of how many times something was done

Details and Assumptions

- Need a way to increment a counter
- Need a way to get the current value

Acceptance Criteria

Given I have incremented the counter to 2

When I make a call to get the current value

Then it should return 2 as the counter value



3. Click anywhere off of the labels menu to close it. You should now see that the label enhancement has been assigned to this story.

Need a service that has a counter

 Open

Zohra538/lab-agile-planning

Public



Zohra538 opened 5 days ago

As a User

I need a service that has a counter

So that I can keep track of how many times something was done

Details and Assumptions

- Need a way to increment a counter
- Need a way to get the current value

Acceptance Criteria

Given I have incremented the counter to 2
When I make a call to get the current value
Then it should return 2 as the counter value

4. Select each of the following stories in the **Product Backlog** column and assign them the corresponding labels.

Story Title	Label
Must persist counter across restarts	enhancement
Deploy service to the cloud	technical debt
Counters can be reset	enhancement
Need ability to update a counter to new value	enhancement

Note: If you have added the labels but cannot see them on the Kanban board, please follow these steps:

1. Open the dropdown menu next to the Backlog (highlighted as 1 in the screenshot below).
2. Click on the arrow next to the Fields option (highlighted as 2).
3. Drag and drop Labels from the Hidden fields list to the Visible fields list (highlighted as 3).
4. Click on the Save button (highlighted as 4) to save the changes.

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Zehra539 / Projects / Lab Agile Planning

Lab Agile Planning

Backlog Board Roadmap

Filter by keyword

New issues 0

Layout

Configuration

Fields: Title, Assignees, Status... >

Column by: Status >

Group by: none >

Sort by: Priority >

Field sum: Count, Estimate >

Slice by: none >

Generate chart

Rename view

Save changes to new view

Delete view

Export view data

Save Discard

Visible fields

Title

Assignee

Status

Priority

Estimate

Labels

Size

Hidden fields

Linked request

Milestone

Repository

Reviewer

Start date

End date

At the end of this exercise, your Kanban board should look like this:

The screenshot displays the GitHub Lab Agile Planning interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with a menu icon, a GitHub logo, and the text "ZehraAfzal / Projects / Lab Agile Planning". A search bar on the right says "Type /". Below this is a header for "Lab Agile Planning" with tabs for "Backlog", "Priority board", "Team items", "Roadmap", "In review", "My items", and a "+ New view" button. A filter bar below the tabs says "Filter by keyword or by field".

The main area is divided into three columns:

- New issues** (0 / 7, Estimate: 0): This column is currently empty.
- Icebox** (2, Estimate: 0): This column contains two items:
 - lab-agile-planning #2: Must allow multiple counters
 - lab-agile-planning #6: Need the ability to remove a counter
- Product Backlog**: This column contains five items, each with a label:
 - lab-agile-planning #1: Need a service that has **enhancement**
 - lab-agile-planning #3: Must persist counter ac **enhancement**
 - lab-agile-planning #5: Deploy service to the c **technical debt**
 - lab-agile-planning #4: Counters can be reset **enhancement**
 - lab-agile-planning #7: Need the ability to upc value **enhancement**

Each column has a "+ Add item" button at the bottom.

Summary

You learned how to triage new issues, add detail to stories to make them sprint ready, create new labels, and assign labels to stories in preparation for a sprint planning meeting.

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